



*Civil Society Network on Migration and Development*  
**(CSOnetMADE)**

**United for Voluntary, Safe and Dignified Migration**

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## **“MIGRANTS AT THE MARGINS” NATIONAL SUMMIT**

*Strengthening Legal Protection, Institutional Recourse and State Accountability in the Face of Xenophobic Violence*

### **1. Summary**

CSOnetMADE and Heartland Alliance Ltd/GTE propose a four-day, multi-constituency National Summit on the human rights of migrants in the face of xenophobic violence, convening the judiciary and legal profession, law enforcement, the media, the diplomatic corps and multilateral institutions, and migrant communities themselves. The Summit converts a recurring humanitarian concern into a standing legal and diplomatic architecture: a remedy ladder for migrant victims, lawful accountability and reparations pathways for states, institutional commitments from those who police, report and adjudicate, and a permanent national network for rapid response, litigation and diplomatic follow-up. Anchored in the Revised National Migration Policy (2025), the Summit addresses protection in both directions: Nigerians abroad and migrants within Nigeria.

### **2. Convening Structure**

- Conveners: Civil Society Network on Migration and Development (CSOnetMADE) • Heartland Alliance Ltd/GTE;
- Proposed Co-Conveners: NCFRMI • Federal Ministry of Foreign Affairs • NAPTIP;
- Proposed Partners: Nigerian Bar Association • IOM • OHCHR • ECOWAS Community Court of Justice • Nigeria Police Force / Police Service Commission • Guild of Editors and media associations;
- Secretariat hosted by CSOnetMADE; Honorary Chair: a retired senior jurist.

### **3. Programme Architecture - Four Days, Four Constituencies**

- Day 1 (Abuja) - Judicial & Legal Day with the NBA: the remedy ladder from domestic courts to the ECOWAS Court and UN treaty bodies; strategic litigation and case documentation; reparations and state responsibility. Deliverable: Model Litigation & Case-Tracking Protocol.
- Day 2 (Abuja) - Law Enforcement & Security Day: the protective duty; failure-to-investigate as state responsibility; command responsibility. Closed-door training orientation. Deliverable: Policing SOP on migrant protection and non-discrimination.
- Day 3 (Abuja) - Diplomatic & Multilateral Flagship Day: state accountability and reparations; the compounding-pressure architecture (regional judgments, treaty body views, HRC resolutions, diplomacy); consular protection of Nigerians abroad; adoption of the official Communiqué; National

Media Charter on Responsible Migration Reporting adopted in plenary. A closed session for ambassadors and foreign ministry legal advisers.

- Day 4 (Umuahia, Abia State) - Community & Survivors' Forum: structured testimonies, legal-aid clinics, psychosocial referral, and dissemination of the remedy ladder in plain language and local languages. Deliverable: documented case register for the Network.

#### 4. Legal and Policy Framework

Customary international law and jus cogens; ICERD Article 4; ICCPR Articles 6, 7, 20(2) and 26; CAT and CMW; the ILC Articles on State Responsibility (2001) grounding reparations claims; the ECOWAS Community Court of Justice, African Court and Commission; UN treaty bodies and Special Rapporteur mechanisms; and nationally the Revised NMP 2025, NAPTIP Act, NHRC Act and the Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria.

#### 5. Enduring Output

The Summit's permanent product is the Migrants' Rights Rapid Response & Litigation Network: a standing mechanism with named focal institutions (NBA branches, NHRC, NAPTIP state offices, CSOnetMADE members), a case register, an annual accountability report and a scheduled biennial convening, converting a four-day event into permanent institutional capacity.

#### 6. Protocol Posture

No state is named as an offender in any public material; case studies are generic in public sessions and specific only in the closed diplomatic session; invitations to destination-country missions are extended as co-stakeholders and co-conveners of protection, an opportunity to demonstrate visible leadership on migrant protection in Africa.

#### 7. What We Seek

Co-sponsorship and funding for conference organisation, interpretation and plain-language materials, speaker and participant travel, Day 4 community logistics in Umuahia, and secretariat costs; technical partnership in developing the four deliverable instruments. Engagement channels include IOM/OHCHR project windows, embassy small-grant schemes and direct sponsorship. An estimated 350–450 participants across the four days.



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